

## Ideation Phase

### Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

|               |                               |
|---------------|-------------------------------|
| Date          | 15 June 2026                  |
| Prepared By   | Sowmya Kella                  |
| Project Name  | ShopEZ E-Commerce Application |
| Maximum Marks | 4 Marks                       |

#### Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization :

##### Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

ShopEZ is a MERN stack e-commerce web application developed as a single-person college project. The problem identified was the lack of a simple, secure, and efficient online shopping platform that caters to both customers and store administrators. The problem statement defined was "How might we build a simple and secure online shopping platform where users can browse products, manage their cart, and place orders, while admins can manage the entire store efficiently?"



### Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

🕒 10 minutes to prepare  
🕒 1 hour to collaborate  
👤 2-5 people recommended

#### Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

🕒 10 minutes

- A** Team gathering  
Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.
- B** Set the goal  
Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.
- C** Learn how to use the facilitation tools  
Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.  
[Open article](#) →

#### 1 Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

🕒 5 minutes

##### PROBLEM

How might we build a simple and secure online shopping platform where users can browse products, manage their cart, and place orders — while admins can manage the entire store efficiently?

##### 2% Key rules of brainstorming

To run a smooth and productive session

- 🗣️ Stay in topic.
- 💡 Encourage wild ideas.
- ⏸️ Defer judgment.
- 👂 Listen to others.
- 🗣️ Go for volume.
- 👁️ If possible, be visual.

## Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

A total of 12 ideas were brainstormed to address the problem statement. These ideas were then grouped into 4 meaningful categories — User Management, Product Management, Cart & Orders, and Admin Controls. User Management covers registration, login, and password security. Product Management includes product search, filtering, and reviews. Cart & Orders covers adding to cart, placing orders, and delivery charges. Admin Controls includes managing products, orders, banners, and users

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### Brainstorm

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

🕒 10 minutes

#### TIP

You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil (switch to sketch) icon to start drawing!

1. Users should be able to register and login securely

2. Products should be searchable by name and category

3. Users should be able to add products to cart

4. Users should be able to place orders with delivery address

5. Admin should be able to add, edit and delete products

6. Admin should be able to update order status

7. Passwords should be encrypted for security

8. Homepage should show promotional banners

9. Users should be able to write product reviews

10. Admin should be able to manage all users

11. Cart should calculate total price automatically

12. Free delivery above ₹500 order value

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## Group ideas

Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. Once all sticky notes have been grouped, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.

🕒 20 minutes

### TIP

Add customizable tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, browse, organize, and categorize important ideas as themes within your mural.

## User Management

1. Users should be able to register and login securely

7. Passwords should be encrypted for security

## Product Management

2. Products should be searchable by name and category

9. Users should be able to write product reviews

## Cart & Orders

3. Users should be able to add products to cart

4. Users should be able to place orders with delivery address

11. Cart should calculate total price automatically

12. Free delivery above ₹500 order value

## Admin Controls

5. Admin should be able to add, edit and delete products

6. Admin should be able to update order status

8. Homepage should show promotional banners

10. Admin should be able to manage all users

## Step-3: Idea Prioritization

The 12 ideas were placed on a prioritization grid based on their importance and feasibility. High importance and easy to build features like user login, product search, add to cart, place orders, and admin product management were prioritized first. Features like password encryption and cart total calculation were marked as important but technically complex. Promotional banners and free delivery were identified as easy but lower priority features. Product reviews and user management were placed as optional features to be implemented later

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## Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

🕒 20 minutes

### TIP

Participants can use their cursors to point at where sticky notes should go on the grid. The facilitator can confirm the spot by using the laser pointer holding the **H** key on the keyboard.

